Field Visit Risk Assessment (Form FVRA-04)

User guide for officers and supervisors, version 2.0 (2018)

Synthetic document for demonstration. Fictional program; not a real government guide. Version française disponible sur demande.

1. Before you start

Complete a Field Visit Risk Assessment before every planned field visit, and update it if the plan changes. The lead officer completes the form. Answer every factor; if you are unsure, choose the answer that best matches what you know today and explain in your visit plan.

The form has three sections. **Likelihood** factors describe how likely something is to go wrong. **Consequence** factors describe how bad it would be. **Mitigation** factors describe what you have in place to reduce the risk. Each factor has a weight, shown next to it on the form.

Table 1. Factor weights

Factor	Section	Weight
Prior hostile contact at site	Likelihood	Critical (10)
Remote or hard-to-reach site	Likelihood	Medium (3)
Working alone	Likelihood	High (5)
Hazardous materials on site	Consequence	Critical (10)
Distance to medical help	Consequence	Medium (3)
Severe weather	Consequence	Low (1)
Check-in plan	Mitigation	High (5)
Second person attending	Mitigation	Medium (3)
Satellite communicator	Mitigation	Low (1)

The screenshots in this guide follow one worked example: a lone officer inspecting a rural storage yard down a gravel road in early spring.

2. Likelihood factors



Figure: the Likelihood section, completed for the worked example.

Prior hostile contact at site (Critical)

Has anyone from the program, or another enforcement or inspection body, had a hostile or threatening interaction at this site or with the people you expect to meet?

None known	You checked the site history and asked the regional office, and found nothing.
Possible	Second-hand or unverified reports, or hostility at a related site.
Likely	A recent pattern of non-cooperation or verbal threats, not yet documented as an incident.
Confirmed	A documented incident at this site in the last five years.

Example: A neighbouring property owner told the last inspector the operator "doesn't like visitors". Nothing is documented. Answer: Possible.

Note. This factor is weighted Critical. If you answer Confirmed, the form displays the Single Critical Factor warning and the assessment requires supervisor approval.

Remote or hard-to-reach site (Medium)

How hard is the site to reach, and how long would it take help to reach you?

None known	Urban or roadside site with cell coverage.
Possible	Rural site, reachable by paved road, patchy coverage.
Likely	Gravel or seasonal road, no coverage on site.
Confirmed	Fly-in, boat access, or a road that is often impassable.

Example: A storage yard 40 minutes down a gravel road with no cell signal. Answer: Likely.

Working alone (High)

Will any officer be working out of sight and sound of another officer?

None known	The team will stay together for the whole visit.
Possible	Short periods apart are possible but not planned.
Likely	The plan splits the team for part of the visit.
Confirmed	One officer is attending alone.

Example: One officer is attending. Answer: Confirmed.

3. Consequence factors



Figure: the Consequence section, completed for the worked example.

Hazardous materials on site (Critical)

Could officers be exposed to hazardous materials on site (fuels, pesticides, unknown chemicals, contaminated soil or water)?

None known	The site has no history of storing or handling hazardous materials.
Possible	Materials might be present, for example an unlabelled container was reported.
Likely	The operator is known to store regulated substances.
Confirmed	A release or exposure is the reason for the visit.

Example: The yard stores equipment only. Answer: None known.

Note. Any indication of hazardous materials (Possible, Likely or Confirmed) displays the Single Critical Factor warning. Contact the regional safety advisor before the visit.

Distance to medical help (Medium)

How far is the nearest medical help that can treat a serious injury?

None known	Under 20 minutes by road.
Possible	20 to 60 minutes by road.
Likely	More than an hour by road.
Confirmed	Air evacuation would be needed.

Example: The nearest hospital is 75 minutes away. Answer: Likely.

Severe weather (Low)

Could weather make the visit or the trip unsafe?

None known	No warnings in the forecast.
Possible	Seasonal risk (ice, heat, storms) but no current warning.
Likely	A weather statement is in effect for the area.
Confirmed	A warning is in effect for the day of the visit.

Example: Early spring, no warnings yet, but roads can ice over. Answer: Possible.

4. Mitigation factors



Figure: the Mitigation section, completed for the worked example.

Check-in plan (High)

Is there a check-in plan with a named contact and set check-in times?

In place and tested	Named contact, set times, and the plan was tested on a previous visit.
In place	Named contact and set times, not yet tested.
Informal	Someone knows where you are going, but there are no set times.
None	No check-in plan.

Example: The team lead will expect a call at 11:00 and 14:00. Answer: In place.

Second person attending (Medium)

Will a second person (officer, police, or trained staff) attend the visit?

In place and tested	A second officer is attending and has worked this site before.
In place	A second person is attending.
Informal	A second person is nearby and can come if called.
None	No second person.

Example: No second officer is available. Answer: None.

Satellite communicator (Low)

Will you carry a satellite communicator or another device that works without cell coverage?

In place and tested	Device issued, charged, and tested this week.
In place	Device issued but not tested recently.
Informal	A device is available at the office but not booked.
None	No device.

Example: The officer has a tested satellite communicator. Answer: In place and tested.

5. Reading the results

Overall risk / Risque global	Moderate
Uncertainty level / Niveau d'incertitude	High
Single critical factor / Facteur critique unique	
Supervisor approval required / Approbation requise	No / Non

Figure: results for the worked example.

Overall risk

The form calculates the overall risk from your answers in the three sections. Higher likelihood and consequence raise the overall risk; stronger mitigation lowers it. The result is shown as Low, Moderate, High or Extreme.

Uncertainty level

The uncertainty level shows how much of your assessment rests on unconfirmed information. Confirmed answers carry the least uncertainty; Possible answers carry the most. The result is shown as Low, Medium or High. If uncertainty is High, gather more information before the visit if you can.

Single critical factor

This field displays a warning if you select the highest answer for any factor whose weight is Critical. A warning means the assessment must go to your supervisor, whatever the overall risk.

Supervisor approval

Supervisor approval is required when the Single Critical Factor warning is displayed, or when the overall risk is High or Extreme. Send the completed form to your supervisor and do not start the visit until it is approved.